



1924–2023 · MIT economist, Nobel laureate (1987).

"Computers everywhere except the productivity statistics."

THE WHY THAT DROVE THE WORK

Solow's growth theory sought to explain what drives long-run economic growth, concluding that technological progress — not just capital — is the main engine.

INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

His neoclassical growth model earned the Nobel Prize; his 1987 quip that the computer age was visible 'everywhere except in the productivity statistics' named the productivity paradox.

FRAMEWORKS ANCHORED IN THIS COURSE

He anchors the Solow Paradox Revisited in Unit 2, the caution that visible technology adoption does not guarantee measured productivity gains.

HOW THE IDEAS OPERATIONALISE

His paradox operationalises as a discipline of looking for lags, mismeasurement and missing complements before concluding a technology has failed.

LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUE

The paradox describes a puzzle more than it prescribes a remedy; its resolution depends on later work on lags and intangibles.

ENDURING IMPACT

Solow's growth theory founded modern growth economics, and the paradox remains the reference point for every debate about technology and productivity.

ON THE SAME PANEL (UNIT 2)

Erik Brynjolfsson · Giant 6

Everett Rogers · Giant 8

Eliyahu Goldratt · Giant 9

Dave McClure · Giant 10

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Solow, R. (1956) 'A contribution to the theory of economic growth', Quarterly Journal of Economics, 70(1).

Solow, R. (1987) 'We'd better watch out', New York Times Book Review.